SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #74 · RESURRECTION & THE BODY

“If my body is cremated, God can’t raise it.”

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Where it often comes from

Worry about a loved one who was cremated. Teaching that cremation is forbidden or makes resurrection impossible. Thinking of resurrection as God needing all the original pieces. Fear of what will happen to your own body. Christians hold different views about whether burial or cremation is better, but the question here is whether God is able.

What Scripture teaches

Whatever happens to a body, God is able to raise it. Bodies return to dust in the grave, are lost at sea, or are destroyed in fires, and God promises that the sea and the grave will give up their dead. The God who formed you in secret and created the heavens and earth by His power says nothing is too difficult for Him. The resurrection does not depend on how a body is laid to rest but on the power of God.

> *“‘Oh, Lord GOD! You have made the heavens and the earth by Your great power and outstretched arm. Nothing is too difficult for You!’”* **(Jeremiah 32:17)**.

Also see

> “And if the Spirit of Him who raised Jesus from the dead is living in you, He who raised Christ Jesus from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through His Spirit, who lives in you” **(Romans 8:11)**.

> “The sea gave up its dead, and Death and Hades gave up their dead, and each one was judged according to his deeds” **(Revelation 20:13)**.

> “By the sweat of your brow you will eat your bread, until you return to the ground— because out of it were you taken. For dust you are, and to dust you shall return” **(Genesis 3:19)**.

> “So will it be with the resurrection of the dead: What is sown is perishable; it is raised imperishable. It is sown in dishonor; it is raised in glory. It is sown in weakness; it is raised in power. It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. If there is a natural body, there is also a spiritual body” **(1 Corinthians 15:42–44)**.

Common self-statements

- My loved one can’t be raised because of cremation.
- God needs the whole body to raise it.
- I made the wrong choice for my loved one.
- Cremation ruins resurrection.
- God won’t be able to find all the pieces.
- My body has to be preserved for God to raise it.

Common logical errors

- **Limiting God:** Picturing God’s power as limited by physical conditions.
- **Catastrophizing:** Fearing the worst about a loved one’s future.
- **Guilt-driven thinking:** Blaming yourself for a choice that does not limit God.

- **Overliteral thinking:** Assuming resurrection must reassemble exact pieces.

Challenging questions

- What happens to every buried body over time?
- Are people lost at sea or in fires beyond God's reach?
- What does Jeremiah 32:17 say is too difficult for God?
- Who created my body in the first place?
- Does resurrection depend on human preservation or on God's power?
- Is my fear coming from Scripture or from something I heard?
- Can I trust God with my loved one's body?

Truth summary

> Cremation does not keep God from raising a body. Every body returns to dust, and God promises to raise the dead from the ground, the sea, and every place. Nothing is too difficult for Him. The resurrection depends on God's power, not on how a body is laid to rest. I can trust Him with my body and my loved ones.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Death/Dying
- God, All Powerful
- Christ, Resurrection of
- Grief
- Eternal Life

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Death and Dying
- Grief

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If my body is cremated, God can't raise it"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If my body is cremated, God can't raise it." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What happens to buried bodies over time?
- ☐ Are people lost at sea beyond God's reach?
- ☐ Is anything too difficult for God?
- ☐ Who created my body?
- ☐ Does resurrection depend on preservation or power?
- ☐ Can I trust God with my loved one?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Nothing is too difficult for God.
- ☐ God will raise the dead from every place.
- ☐ The resurrection depends on God's power.
- ☐ The Spirit who raised Jesus will give life to mortal bodies.
- ☐ I can trust God with my body and my loved ones.
- ☐ My body will be raised imperishable.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Jeremiah 32:17**
  "'Oh, Lord GOD! You have made the heavens and the earth by Your great power and outstretched arm. Nothing is too difficult for You!'"
- [ ] **Romans 8:11**
  "And if the Spirit of Him who raised Jesus from the dead is living in you, He who raised Christ Jesus from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through His Spirit, who lives in you."
- [ ] **Revelation 20:13**
  "The sea gave up its dead, and Death and Hades gave up their dead, and each one was judged according to his deeds."
- [ ] **Genesis 3:19**
  "By the sweat of your brow you will eat your bread, until you return to the ground— because out of it were you taken. For dust you are, and to dust you shall return."
- [ ] **1 Corinthians 15:42–44**
  "So will it be with the resurrection of the dead: What is sown is perishable; it is raised imperishable. It is sown in dishonor; it is raised in glory. It is sown in weakness; it is raised in power. It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. If there is a natural body, there is also a spiritual body."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **God is able journal:** Each day, write one thing God has done that shows He is able.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Romans 8:11 becomes: "And if the Spirit of Him who raised Jesus from the dead is living in **Sarah**, He who raised Christ Jesus from the dead will also give life to **her** mortal body through His Spirit, who lives in **her**."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "God, All Powerful" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read Jeremiah 32:16–27,** and write every phrase about God's power.
- ☐ **If you feel guilt about a loved one's cremation,** write a prayer giving that guilt to God.
- ☐ **Read 1 Corinthians 15:35–44,** and write how a seed becomes something new.
- ☐ **Talk with your pastor** about your church's view of burial and cremation.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If my body is cremated, God can't raise it": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One reminder that God is able
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If my body is cremated, God can't raise it.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Almighty God, nothing is too difficult for You. Help me reject the fear that cremation keeps You from raising a body. Thank You that the Spirit who raised Jesus will give life to mortal bodies. I trust You with my body and with the people I love. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.